

Chainlink Labs — Data Risk Operations Analyst

Application Packet · Josh Stokesberry · July 3, 2026 · Remote (United States) · Product dept.

Status: SEND-READY. Posting verified live 2026-07-03 — jobs.ashbyhq.com/chainlink-labs/f61557c3. Role: monitor and mitigate risk and data quality across Chainlink's data products — triage alerts, debug feed issues, build risk tooling, coordinate with data providers and node operators.

Fit Assessment (honest)

Why this is the #1 target: Josh co-contributed S&P Global's **published research on blockchain oracle risk** ("Utility at a Cost: Assessing the Risks of Blockchain Oracles" — data quality, concentration risk, cross-chain communication) — the literal domain of this team. Add 6+ years of institutional risk operations at S&P Global (\$10B+ in syndicated loan settlements: monitoring, exception triage, escalation, multi-party coordination) and years of hands-on DeFi use (Aave, Curve, Convex, Pendle). A finance-native risk operator who already thinks in oracle-dependency terms.

The honest gap: the posting asks for working SQL / JSON / Python (Pandas) / REST. Josh's tooling is *foundational*, not deep. The materials state this plainly — "working foundations, sharpened daily with AI-assisted workflows" — and lead with judgment + domain instead.

TASTE-GATE FLAG — read before sending: the role includes an on-call rotation "every few weeks," including some weekends — weigh against the newborn. Counterweight: fully remote, EST-overlap friendly from Central, and this is the one company where your exact thesis is the day job.

Tailored Resume Bullets (verified claims only)

S&P Global — Financial Operations Analyst (Oct 2019 – present)

- Facilitated \$10B+ in primary and secondary syndicated loan trades; monitored settlement status, documentation, funding requirements, and exceptions across clients, counterparties, custodians, agent banks, and legal stakeholders.
- Led analyst coverage for multiple bank and fund-management client portfolios, balancing daily execution, escalation, prioritization, and risk controls.
- Converted status signals, documentation gaps, and settlement blockers into clear operational priorities; reduced recurring blockers by streamlining follow-up routines (ClearPar, WSO, Excel).

S&P Global — crypto/blockchain research contributor (2023 – 2025)

- Contributed to S&P Global research assessing blockchain oracle utility and risks: off-chain data, cross-chain communication, concentration risk, data quality, and DeFi/TradFi interoperability.
- Contributed to S&P Global thought leadership on AI/crypto convergence (data integrity, decentralized infrastructure, financial markets, IoT, supply chains).

Independent — DeFi / market-infrastructure researcher (ongoing)

- Hands-on user of major DeFi protocols (Aave, Curve, Convex, Pendle, Aerodrome) with a risk-first lens: oracle/data dependencies, liquidity depth, collateral mechanics, governance, operational controls.
- Designed dashboard concepts tracking oracle dependency and onchain infrastructure adoption; built an AI-assisted operations command center (Git-based workflows, scheduled agents, Python-scripted reporting) — working foundations in Python/Pandas, SQL concepts, JSON/REST APIs.

Cover Note (draft — Josh’s voice, ~200 words)

I’ve spent six years inside institutional risk operations at S&P Global — facilitating over \$10B in syndicated loan settlements, where my job was essentially the one described in this posting: monitor a portfolio for risk signals, triage exceptions, debug issues across many counterparties, and turn ambiguity into process.

In parallel, I contributed to S&P Global’s published crypto research — including our report on blockchain oracle risks (data quality, concentration risk, cross-chain communication) and our AI/crypto convergence outlook. Writing about oracle risk for an institutional audience convinced me the most interesting operational problems in finance are moving onchain — and most of them route through Chainlink.

I’ve been a hands-on DeFi user for years (Aave, Curve, Convex, Pendle), so I know the feed-consumer side of your data products personally. My tooling is honest rather than flashy: working Python/Pandas and SQL foundations that I sharpen daily with AI-assisted workflows — my judgment about which risks matter is where I’d add value on day one.

I’d love to help the Data Risk Operations team keep the industry’s most load-bearing data infrastructure boring and reliable.

Application Form Prep (Ashby)

- **Work authorization:** [JOSH — confirm exact wording]
- **Location:** Oklahoma City, OK (Central Time — overlaps EST core hours)
- **Salary (if asked):** “flexible; targeting market rate for the role.” Do NOT anchor below market. [floor \$75K; this role likely pays well above — discuss before entering a number]
- **How did you hear about us:** careers page / long-time ecosystem participant.

Honesty Guardrails (do not cross)

- No authorship claims on the third S&P report (interoperability/tokenization) — contribution unverified; it stays out of all materials.
- “Contributor” phrasing only for the two verified reports — never “author.”
- Tooling stays “working foundations” — never “proficient/expert.”

Send Checklist (~15 minutes)

1. Read the fit assessment + on-call flag. Verdict: ship / kill / one line why.
2. Resume file: paste the bullets into your current resume — or tell Claude “build the resume doc” for a ready .docx.
3. Confirm salary + work-authorization answers.
4. Submit at the posting link, then tell Commander: “shipped CI-1 Chainlink.” Scoreboard’s first real point.